Appendix C: Sample Assessment Tool (BSBPMG536 Manage project risk)

Unit	BSBPMG536 Manage project risk (Release 1)
Training package	BSB Business Services, Version 7.0
Qualification	BSB50820 Diploma of Project Management (core unit)
Assessment methods	Written questions · Simulated project portfolio · Stakeholder meeting role-play (observed) · Workplace or second simulated project
Version / date	Sample v1.0, prepared by [Name], [Date]
Validation status	Not yet validated. For RTO pre-use review

Part A: Assessment overview

A1. Summary of tasks

Task	Method	What the candidate submits	Indicative time
1	Written knowledge questions	Answers to 9 questions	2–3 hours
2	Simulated project: Project 1 (Northgate Mine radio network upgrade)	Risk management plan, risk register, treatment plan, monitoring update, close-out review	8–10 hours
3	Stakeholder risk workshop: role-play (part of Project 1)	Participation (observed) + meeting record + stakeholder feedback form	45–60 min
4	Project 2: workplace project, or simulated scenario (Coastal Council ERP migration)	Risk register, treatment plan, monitoring log, stakeholder feedback, lessons learned report	6–8 hours

To be assessed as competent, the candidate must complete **all four tasks to a satisfactory standard**. Tasks 2–4 meet the performance evidence requirement to *manage project risk on at least two occasions* (Project 1 and Project 2).

A2. Assessment conditions

- **Environment:** a workplace or a simulated environment that reflects real conditions. The Northgate and Coastal Council scenarios give the candidate realistic project documentation and constraints.
- **Resources supplied:** Scenario Packs A and B (Appendix 1), risk register and plan templates (Appendix 2), and a stakeholder feedback form (Appendix 3). The candidate may also use AS ISO 31000 (Risk management – Guidelines) or their organisation’s risk framework.
- **Stakeholder feedback:** must come from the people who play stakeholders in the Task 3 role-play (Project 1), and from real workplace stakeholders or role-players (Project 2). This satisfies

the assessment condition requiring *feedback from project stakeholders about how risks were managed*.
- **Assessor:** must meet the trainer and assessor credential and vocational competency requirements of the current Standards for RTOs.

A3. Candidate instructions

1. Read all instructions and the scenario packs before you start.
2. All work must be your own. Name any frameworks, standards or sources you use.
3. You may ask your assessor to clarify task instructions, but not to give you the answers.
4. If your work is unsatisfactory, you will receive feedback and **one** opportunity to resubmit each task. Further attempts are at the RTO's discretion.
5. Talk to your assessor if you need reasonable adjustment (for example, extra time, a verbal response format, or assistive technology). Adjustments change *how* you're assessed, not the standard required.
6. You can appeal any assessment decision through the RTO's complaints and appeals policy.

A4. Assessor instructions

- Use the **benchmark answers and marking criteria** in each task. Benchmarks show what's expected. Accept equivalent answers that meet the criteria.
- Record S (satisfactory) or NYS (not yet satisfactory) against every criterion. All criteria must be S for the task to be S.
- For Task 3, complete the observation checklist during or straight after the role-play. You or a trained role-player may play stakeholders.
- For Task 4 using a workplace project, check authenticity: use the third-party verification in Appendix 3, or a short verbal discussion recorded on the assessor record.
- Complete the Assessment Record (Part C) and give written feedback.

Part B: Assessment tasks

Task 1: Written knowledge questions

Instructions to candidate: Answer all questions in your own words. Suggested length is shown for each. You may refer to standards and texts, but you must name them.

Q1. Name **five** risk categories that commonly apply to projects. Give a specific example risk for each. *(Suggested: 150–250 words)*

> **Benchmark:** Any five relevant categories, each with an example that clearly fits, e.g.: - **Technical:** a new system is incompatible with legacy equipment. - **Schedule:** a long-lead component is delivered late. - **Financial/cost:** an exchange-rate movement increases import costs. - **Resource/people:** a key specialist leaves mid-project. - **Safety/WHS:** work at height during an installation. - **Environmental:** extreme weather stops site access. - **Legal/regulatory:** a licence or permit is delayed. - **Stakeholder/organisational:** the sponsor's priorities change. - **Supplier/procurement:** a subcontractor becomes insolvent. - **Security/information:** a data breach during a system migration.
>
> **Criteria:** at least five distinct categories; every example plausibly belongs to its category.

Q2. List the **key components** of a project risk management plan and briefly explain the purpose of each. *(Suggested: 200–300 words)*

> **Benchmark:** Must include at least **six**: - **Objectives and scope** of risk management. - **Roles and responsibilities** (risk owner, project manager, sponsor). - **Methodology and tools.** - **Risk criteria:** likelihood and consequence scales and a risk matrix. - **Risk appetite or tolerance thresholds.** - **Identification and analysis processes.** - **Treatment approach.** - **Monitoring and review schedule.** - **Reporting and escalation.** - **Budget or contingency** for risk. - **Communication and consultation approach.** - **The risk register** as the controlling document.
>
> **Criteria:** six or more components; each purpose is correct.

Q3. Explain the difference between a **risk control** that already exists and a **risk treatment**. Give one project example of each. *(Suggested: 100–150 words)*

> **Benchmark:** - An **existing control** is a measure already in place that changes the risk before any new action is taken. Example: an existing permit-to-work system for electrical isolation. - A **treatment** is a new action chosen to modify the risk further after analysis. Example: adding a second, independent supplier for a critical component.
>
> **Criteria:** the distinction is correct; both examples are appropriate.

Q4. Describe the **four common risk treatment strategies for threats** and **two strategies for opportunities**. *(Suggested: 150–200 words)*

> **Benchmark:** - **Threats** (four): **avoid**, **reduce or mitigate**, **transfer or share** (e.g. insurance, contract terms) and **accept or retain**. Also accept “escalate” as an additional strategy. - **Opportunities** (two): any two of **exploit**, **enhance**, **share**, **accept**.
>
> **Criteria:** four correct threat strategies and two correct opportunity strategies, each briefly explained.

Q5. Explain how **industry sector** affects risk classification. Compare how a risk might be classified in a **mining or heavy industrial** project versus an **office IT** project. *(Suggested: 150–250 words)*

> **Benchmark:** - Industries weight consequence categories differently and have different regulatory contexts. - **Mining/industrial** examples: safety consequences dominate, with fatality-potential risks often rated as critical regardless of likelihood; critical-control management applies, and environmental and licence-to-operate risks matter. - **Office IT** examples: data, privacy and service-availability consequences dominate. - **Comparison:** the same risk category, such as a power outage, may be rated catastrophic on a mine site (because safety systems fail) but moderate in an office (temporary productivity loss).
>
> **Criteria:** explains why classification varies; gives a valid comparison.

Q6. Name **two** organisational or industry-standard risk frameworks and summarise the core process each describes. *(Suggested: 150–200 words)*

> **Benchmark:** Any two of: - **AS ISO 31000:2018** (communication and consultation; scope, context and criteria; risk assessment covering identification, analysis and evaluation; treatment;

monitoring and review; recording and reporting). - **PMBOK® risk management** (plan, identify, perform qualitative analysis, perform quantitative analysis, plan responses, implement responses, monitor). - **PRINCE2® risk theme** (identify, assess, plan, implement, communicate). - **COSO ERM.** - **An organisation's enterprise risk framework**, described accurately.

Criteria: two frameworks correctly named; the core process accurately summarised.

Q7. Outline the **steps of a project risk management process** from start to close-out, including how risks are reviewed during the project. *(Suggested: 150–200 words)*

Benchmark: 1. Plan the approach and set criteria. 2. Establish context. 3. Identify risks. 4. Analyse likelihood and consequence. 5. Evaluate and prioritise. 6. Plan and implement treatments, assigning owners. 7. Monitor and review at a regular frequency (e.g. fortnightly reviews, standing agenda item, triggers). 8. Report and escalate. 9. Close out and capture lessons learned.

Criteria: a logical sequence including monitoring/review and close-out.

Q8. Explain the difference between **qualitative** and **quantitative** risk analysis. Name **two techniques of each** and say when each type is most appropriate. *(Suggested: 200–300 words)*

Benchmark: - **Qualitative** analysis rates risks on descriptive or ordinal scales. Techniques: probability/impact matrix, risk categorisation, expert judgement, Delphi, bow-tie, risk urgency assessment. - **Quantitative** analysis assigns numerical values to the effect on objectives. Techniques: expected monetary value (EMV), Monte Carlo simulation, decision tree analysis, sensitivity (tornado) analysis, schedule risk analysis. - **When to use:** qualitative for all projects and for initial prioritisation; quantitative for high-value or complex projects, or when contingency must be justified numerically.

Criteria: correct distinction; two valid techniques of each; appropriate guidance on when to use each.

Q9. A risk has a 20% probability of occurring and would cost $150,000 if it occurred. A mitigation costs $18,000 and reduces the probability to 5%. Calculate the **expected monetary value (EMV)** before and after mitigation, and state whether the mitigation is justified on cost grounds. Show your working. *(Numeracy)*

Benchmark: - EMV before = 0.20 × $150,000 = **$30,000**. - EMV after = 0.05 × $150,000 = **$7,500**. - Reduction = **$22,500**, which is more than the $18,000 cost. - **Conclusion:** justified, with a net benefit of $4,500. Also accept discussion of non-financial factors.

Criteria: both calculations correct; correct conclusion; working shown.

Task 1 marking: all nine questions must be S. Questions answered incorrectly may be followed up verbally once; record the follow-up on the assessor record.

Task 2: Project 1, Northgate Mine radio network upgrade (simulated)

Scenario summary (full pack in Appendix 1A): You are the project manager for Northgate Mining's upgrade of its site radio network, from an ageing analog system to a digital trunked system. The

project runs for 9 months on a $2.4M budget. It covers surface and underground areas, and the system carries emergency and duress communications. Stakeholders are the Operations Manager (sponsor), the Site Emergency Services Coordinator, the IT/OT Manager, the vendor's project lead, the Underground Superintendent and the Site Safety Advisor.

Instructions to candidate: using the scenario pack and templates, produce the following.

2.1 Risk management plan *(PC 1.1, 1.2, 2.1, 4.1)*

- State the risk objectives and the standards or framework you'll apply, and show how stakeholder input shaped them. Use the stakeholder interview notes in the pack.
- Describe the project risk context: internal, external, regulatory and operational.
- Define likelihood and consequence scales and a risk matrix suited to a mine site. Justify any departures from the generic matrix in the pack.
- Set out the risk review process: frequency, forums, triggers, roles and escalation.

2.2 Risk identification and register *(PC 1.3, 2.2, 2.4, 3.1)*

- Identify **at least 12 risks** across **at least 5 categories**, including **at least 2 opportunities**. Name the identification methods you used, and why they're valid and reliable for this project (e.g. document review, a review of the pack's lessons-learned log, assumptions analysis, a prompt list or checklist, expert interview notes).
- For each risk, record: cause–event–effect description, category, existing controls, likelihood, consequence, inherent rating, owner.
- Identify any risks that fall outside your delegated authority (see delegation limits in the pack) and how you'd escalate them.

2.3 Prioritisation and treatment plan *(PC 2.3, 3.2, 3.3, 3.4)*

- Prioritise the top 6 risks. Explain how priorities were agreed with the client and stakeholders. This is demonstrated in Task 3.
- For each top-6 risk, analyse **at least two treatment options**, recommend one with reasons, and record the agreed treatment, residual rating, owner, due date and cost or effort.
- Update the plan and register to show responsibilities allocated to team members.

2.4 Monitoring update *(PC 4.2, 4.3, 4.4)* Your assessor will give you **Scenario Update 1** at month 4. It contains three changed circumstances: a vendor component recall, a 6-week delay to a mine-plan change that affects underground coverage, and a newly identified interference issue with a neighbouring licensee.

- Identify how each change affects existing risks or creates new ones.
- Evaluate whether current responses are still adequate.
- Implement agreed responses: update the register, the plan and the schedule or budget implications, and write a short (one-page) risk status report to the sponsor.

2.5 Close-out review *(PC 5.1, 5.2, 5.3)* Using **Scenario Update 2** (project close data), write a risk management close-out review (800–1,200 words) that:

- evaluates how effective the risk processes and procedures were, using evidence from the register history;
- recommends improvements for future projects;
- documents the risk management issues and lessons learned in the organisation's lessons-learned template.

Task 2 marking criteria

#	The candidate has…	S/NYS
2a	Stated risk objectives and standards, showing stakeholder input (PC 1.1)	
2b	Described internal, external, regulatory and operational context (PC 1.2)	
2c	Used and justified at least two valid identification methods; ≥12 risks, ≥5 categories, ≥2 opportunities (PC 1.3)	
2d	Defined classification criteria and applied them consistently to a ranking system (PC 2.1)	
2e	Analysed risks within delegated authority and identified escalation needs (PC 2.2)	
2f	Documented analysis outcomes in the register and plan (PC 2.4)	
2g	Identified and documented existing controls (PC 3.1)	
2h	Analysed ≥2 treatment options per top-6 risk with a justified recommendation (PC 3.2)	
2i	Recorded agreed treatments with residual rating, owner, date and cost (PC 3.3)	
2j	Updated plans and allocated responsibilities (PC 3.4)	
2k	Set out a workable review process (PC 4.1)	
2l	Identified the effect of all three changed circumstances (PC 4.2)	
2m	Evaluated the adequacy of existing responses (PC 4.3)	
2n	Updated the register and plan, and produced a sponsor status report (PC 4.4)	
2o	Evaluated process effectiveness using evidence (PC 5.1)	
2p	Made practical, specific improvement recommendations (PC 5.2)	
2q	Documented issues and lessons in the template (PC 5.3)	
2r	Used quantitative or qualitative techniques appropriately, including at least one quantitative technique for a top-6 risk (PE; KE 7)	

#	The candidate has…	S/NYS
2s	Documents use the required formats and are clear, accurate and professional (FS: writing)	

Task 3: Stakeholder risk workshop (role-play, observed)

Instructions to candidate: run a 30–45 minute risk prioritisation workshop for Project 1 with 2–3 stakeholders, played by your assessor or role-players. Briefs for the stakeholders are in the assessor pack. In the workshop you must:

1. Present your draft top risks and the risk criteria.
2. Get stakeholder input and handle at least one disagreement about priority (built into the role-player briefs).
3. Agree priorities and treatment options with the "client" (the Operations Manager).
4. Confirm actions and owners.

Afterwards, submit: a meeting record (agreed priorities, decisions, actions) and the **stakeholder feedback forms** completed by the role-players (Appendix 3).

Observation checklist

#	The candidate…	S/NYS	Assessor comments
3a	Presented risks and criteria clearly using plain language (FS: oral communication)		
3b	Used active listening and questioning to confirm understanding		
3c	Sought input from each stakeholder (PC 1.1)		
3d	Managed the disagreement constructively and reached agreement (PC 2.3)		
3e	Used consultative methods to compare treatment options (PC 3.2)		
3f	Confirmed priorities, actions and owners with the client (PC 2.3, 3.4)		
3g	Worked within delegated authority and noted escalations (PC 2.2)		
3h	Produced an accurate meeting record		

#	The candidate…	S/NYS	Assessor comments
3i	Obtained completed stakeholder feedback forms (AC)		

Task 4: Project 2, second occasion of managing project risk

Choose **Option A** (a workplace project) or **Option B** (simulated). Both must cover the full cycle: identify → analyse → treat → monitor → review.

Option A: Workplace project. Use a current or recent project you managed or co-managed, lasting at least 3 months. Remove confidential information, and get your employer's approval to submit the material.

Option B: Coastal Council ERP migration. Scenario Pack B (Appendix 1B) covers a council's migration of finance and payroll from an on-premises system to a cloud ERP: a 12-month project with a $1.1M budget. Its risks include privacy, cutover, change resistance and an end-of-financial-year deadline. Scenario Update 3 is issued mid-way.

Submit:

1. Project context summary (300–500 words), including your role and delegated authority.
2. A risk register with at least 10 risks, existing controls, ratings, owners and treatments.
3. The treatment plan for the top 5 risks, with options analysis.
4. A monitoring log showing **at least two review points**, including the response to a changed circumstance (real for Option A; Scenario Update 3 for Option B).
5. **Stakeholder feedback** on how risks were managed: from at least 2 stakeholders (Option A, third-party form in Appendix 3) or from role-players (Option B).
6. A lessons-learned report (500–800 words) with recommended improvements.
7. **Option A only:** a third-party verification signed by your supervisor or project sponsor.

Task 4 marking criteria

#	The candidate has…	S/NYS
4a	Described a project of sufficient complexity, with their role and authority (PE)	
4b	Identified risks using appropriate methods, with risk objectives aligned to stakeholder input (PC 1.1–1.3)	
4c	Analysed, rated and prioritised risks in agreement with stakeholders (PC 2.1–2.4)	
4d	Documented existing controls and analysed treatment options (PC 3.1–3.2)	
4e	Implemented and recorded treatments and allocated responsibilities (PC 3.3–3.4)	

#	The candidate has…	S/NYS
4f	Reviewed risks at two or more points and responded to changed circumstances (PC 4.1–4.4)	
4g	Obtained stakeholder feedback on risk management (AC)	
4h	Evaluated outcomes and documented improvements (PC 5.1–5.3)	
4i	Option A: the third-party verification confirms authenticity	

Part C: Assessment record

Task	Attempt 1 (S/NYS, date)	Attempt 2 (S/NYS, date)	Assessor initials
1 Knowledge questions			
2 Project 1 portfolio			
3 Stakeholder workshop			
4 Project 2			
Unit outcome	☐ Competent (C) ☐ Not Yet Competent (NYC)		

Feedback to candidate: _____

Assessor declaration: I declare that I have conducted a fair, valid, reliable and flexible assessment with this candidate and have given appropriate feedback.

Assessor name / signature / date: _____

Candidate declaration: I declare that the work submitted is my own and I have been given feedback on my result.

Candidate name / signature / date: _____

Part D: Mapping matrix

D1. Elements and performance criteria

PC	Requirement (summary)	T1	T2	T3	T4
1.1	Risk objectives and standards, with stakeholder input	Q6	2.1 (2a)	3c	4b
1.2	Risk context	Q5	2.1 (2b)		4a, 4b

PC	Requirement (summary)	T1	T2	T3	T4
1.3	Valid and reliable identification methods		2.2 (2c)		4b
2.1	Classification criteria and ranking system	Q5	2.1 (2d)		4c
2.2	Analyse within delegated authority	Q8	2.2 (2e)	3g	4c
2.3	Priorities agreed with client and stakeholders		2.3	3d, 3f	4c
2.4	Document analysis in register and plan	Q2	2.2 (2f)		4c
3.1	Identify and document existing controls	Q3	2.2 (2g)		4d
3.2	Analyse treatment options consultatively	Q4	2.3 (2h)	3e	4d
3.3	Record and implement agreed treatments		2.3 (2i)		4e
3.4	Update plans and allocate responsibilities		2.3 (2j)	3f	4e
4.1	Establish risk review processes	Q7	2.1 (2k)		4f
4.2	Monitor environment and changed circumstances		2.4 (2l)		4f
4.3	Evaluate responses to change		2.4 (2m)		4f
4.4	Implement responses and modify plans		2.4 (2n)		4f
5.1	Review effectiveness of risk processes		2.5 (2o)		4h

PC	Requirement (summary)	T1	T2	T3	T4
5.2	Develop recommended improvements		2.5 (2p)		4h
5.3	Document issues and improvements		2.5 (2q)		4h

D2. Performance evidence

Requirement	Evidence
Manage project risk on at least two occasions	Occasion 1: Tasks 2 + 3 (Northgate). Occasion 2: Task 4 (workplace or Coastal Council)
Conduct effective risk management for a project of sufficient complexity	T2 (multi-stakeholder, safety-critical, $2.4M); T4 (4a)
Apply risk management techniques, strategies and tools	T2 (2c, 2d, 2h, 2r); T4 (4b–4f)

D3. Knowledge evidence

Requirement	Evidence
Project risks in a range of risk categories	T1 Q1; T2 2c
Key components of a risk management plan	T1 Q2; T2 2.1
Relevant project risk controls	T1 Q3; T2 2g
Industry sector risk classifications and contexts	T1 Q5; T2 2d
Organisational and industry-standard risk frameworks	T1 Q6; T2 2a
Risk management processes and procedures	T1 Q7; T2 2k
Qualitative and quantitative techniques	T1 Q8, Q9; T2 2r

D4. Foundation skills

Skill	Evidence
Reading	T2 (interpreting the scenario pack, standards, delegations); T4
Writing	T2 2s; T2 2.5; T4 6
Oral communication	T3 3a, 3b
Numeracy	T1 Q9; T2 2d, 2r
Self-management	T2 2e (delegated authority); T3 3g
Teamwork	T3 3c–3f; T2 2n (sponsor report)
Planning and organising	T2 2.1–2.4; T4 4f

D5. Assessment conditions

Condition	How it’s met
Workplace or simulated environment typical of industry	Realistic scenario packs (T2, T4-B) or workplace project (T4-A)
Access to workplace documentation and resources	Scenario packs and templates (Appendices 1–2), or the workplace’s own documents
Feedback from project stakeholders on how risks were managed	T3 feedback forms (3i); T4 item 5 (4g)
Assessor requirements	Part A2

Appendices (outline; full versions supplied with the RTO pack)

Appendix 1A: Scenario Pack A, Northgate Mine radio network upgrade. Company profile, project charter, scope, schedule, budget, delegation limits, generic 5×5 risk matrix, stakeholder interview notes (6), lessons-learned log from a previous site project, Scenario Update 1 (month 4), Scenario Update 2 (close-out data).

Appendix 1B: Scenario Pack B, Coastal Council ERP migration. Council profile, business case extract, project plan, privacy obligations summary, stakeholder notes, Scenario Update 3.

Appendix 2: Templates. Risk management plan, risk register (Excel), treatment options analysis, risk status report, lessons-learned template.

Appendix 3: Forms. Stakeholder feedback form (role-play and workplace versions), third-party verification form.

Assessor pack (separate, not given to candidates). Role-player briefs for Task 3, including the scripted disagreement. Benchmark risk register for Northgate. Expected impacts for Scenario Updates 1–3.

Sample prepared to demonstrate assessment-development capability. Mapped against BSBPMG536 Release 1 as published on training.gov.au. Requires RTO validation before use.